

Patient Identification

Policy Number	POL-PS-008	Owner / Department	Patient Safety / Nursing
Effective Date	2023-01-10	Version	2.6
Last Revised	2026-01-30	Next Review	2028-01-30
Approved By	Patient Safety & Quality Committee	Applies To	All staff at every point of care, treatment, and service

1. Purpose

To reliably identify the individual as the person for whom a service or treatment is intended and to match the service or treatment to that individual, per The Joint Commission NPSG.01.01.01.

2. Policy

- Use at least two patient identifiers — typically full name and date of birth, or name and medical record number — before any care, treatment, medication, blood, specimen collection, or procedure.
- A room or bed number is never an acceptable identifier.
- Actively confirm identifiers with the patient when possible (ask them to state name and date of birth) rather than reading them aloud for confirmation.
- Label specimens in the presence of the patient, at the point of collection.

3. Severity & Reporting

A misidentification that reaches the patient (wrong patient treated, wrong specimen resulted, wrong blood administered) is at least SEV-2 and, where it causes serious harm or involves blood, SEV-1. An identification error caught before reaching the patient is a Near Miss and is still reported under POL-RM-013.

4. References

- The Joint Commission, NPSG.01.01.01 — Identify Patients Correctly.
- Related: POL-SURG-007, POL-LAB-006, POL-RM-013.